MZ2POL-04: Policies and Boundaries

> **Series:** MZ2POL — Management Zone to Policy Migration | **Notebook:** 5 of 14 | **Created:** December 2025 | **Last Updated:** 10/13/2026

Overview

This notebook provides a comprehensive guide to **IAM Policies** and **Policy Boundaries** - the two components that together replace Management Zone access control. Policies define **WHAT** users can do, while boundaries define **WHERE** those permissions apply.

Table of Contents

1. Understanding the Relationship
2. Policy Fundamentals
3. Default Policies
4. Condition and Boundary Syntax
5. Creating Boundaries
6. Best Practice: One Boundary That Covers Every Domain
7. Recommended Group-Policy-Boundary Structure
8. Mapping MZ Access to Policies + Boundaries
9. Security Context and Bucket Strategy
10. Custom Policies
11. Best Practices
12. Troubleshooting
13. Additional Resources

Prerequisites

- Completed MZ2POL-01 through MZ2POL-03
- Access to Dynatrace Account Management
- Policy Management permissions

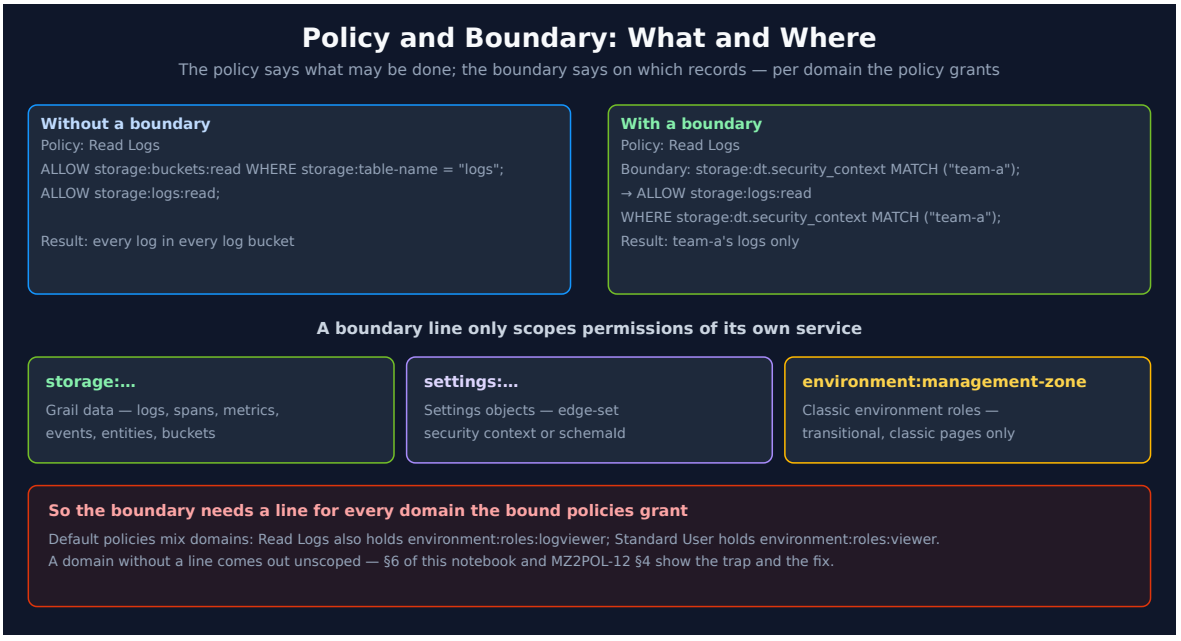
Learning Objectives

By the end of this notebook, you will:
1. Understand policy statement syntax and structure
2. Know the default policies and when to use them
3. Understand boundary syntax and how boundaries restrict policies
4. Be able to map MZ access patterns to policy + boundary combinations
5. Know the recommended group-policy-boundary structure for SAML/AD integration

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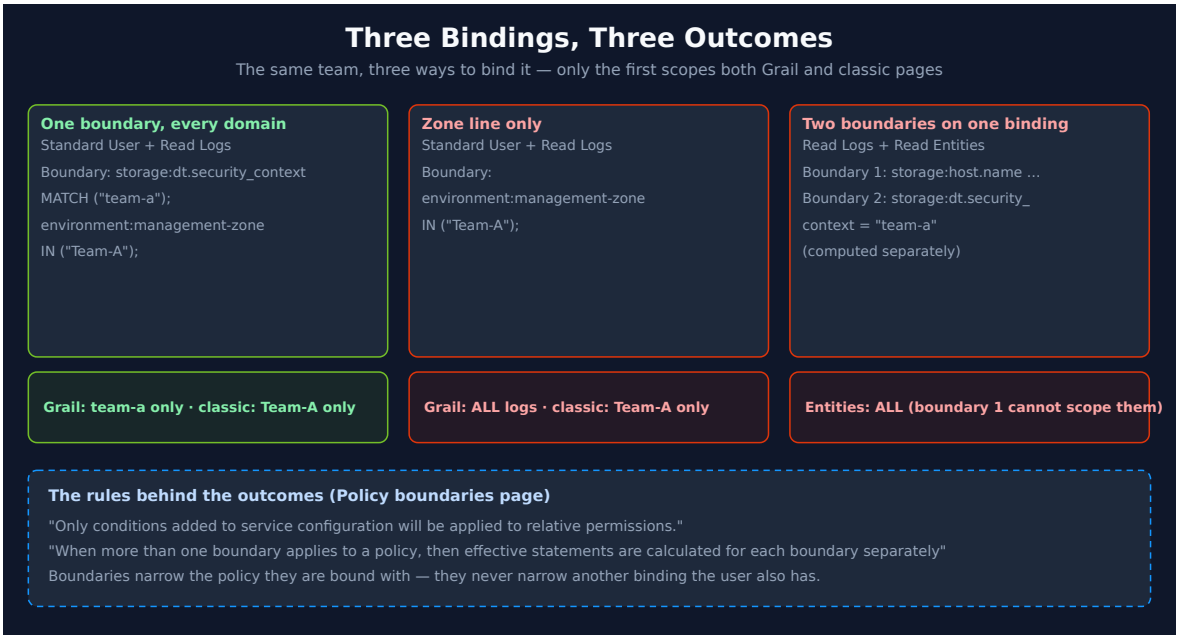
1. Understanding the Relationship

Policies vs Boundaries



Component	Purpose	Analogy
Policy	Defines WHAT actions are allowed	"You can read logs"
Boundary	Defines WHERE policies apply	"...but only for team-frontend"

How They Work Together



Key Characteristics

Policies:
- Define permissions (ALLOW statements)
- Can include conditions (WHERE clauses)
- Default policies cover most use cases

Boundaries:
- Separate from policies (decoupled)
- Reusable across multiple policies
- Can only narrow the policy they are bound with — but several boundaries on one binding are evaluated separately, so a permission one boundary cannot scope comes out unscoped (MZ2POL-12 §4)
- Optional - policies work without them (full scope)

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2. Policy Fundamentals

Policy Statement Structure

```
&lt;effect&gt; &lt;service&gt;:&lt;resource&gt;:&lt;action&gt; [WHERE &lt;condition&gt;]
```

Component	Description	Examples
Effect	Permission type	`ALLOW` or `DENY` (a `DENY` always overrules a matching `ALLOW`)
Service	Dynatrace service	`storage`, `settings`, `app`
Resource	Resource type	`logs`, `buckets`, `objects`
Action	Operation	`read`, `write`, `delete`
Condition	Optional filter	`WHERE field = "value"`

Effects: Authorization is **implicit-deny** — anything not `ALLOW`ed is denied. Compose access from `ALLOW` statements and simply omit what you don't want to grant. Reserve explicit `DENY` for narrowing a broad `ALLOW`; a `DENY` always wins over any `ALLOW`, regardless of order — but see the caveat below on what a `DENY` can and cannot narrow.

Combining conditions: A policy `WHERE` clause supports `AND` (e.g. `WHERE settings:schemaId = "..." AND storage:bucket-name = "logs_prod"`). It does **not** support `OR` — to express OR, write multiple `ALLOW` statements.

⚠️ **`DENY` cannot narrow a grant by record-level condition — it removes the permission outright.** A `WHERE` on a `DENY` behaves differently depending on what it scopes:

Statement	What it actually does
`DENY storage:buckets:read WHERE storage:bucket-name = "logs_delivery"`	Works as written — denies only that bucket

Statement	What it actually does
`DENY storage:logs:read WHERE storage:dt.security_context = "sensitive"`	**Denies every log**, not only the `sensitive` ones

Dynatrace states it plainly: this kind of scoped exclusion *"is only possible with buckets. This is because you can apply a DQL `DENY` statement to buckets, but not to record-level permissions."*

Why this matters for an MZ migration specifically. The instinct carried over from Management Zones is to grant broadly and then carve out the one zone a team must not see. There is no record-level `DENY` that does this. Two options that work:

1. **Grant the complement** — enumerate what the group *may* see with `ALLOW ... WHERE storage:dt.security_context MATCH (...)` instead of excluding what it may not.
2. **Isolate, then deny the bucket** — route the excluded data to its own bucket and `DENY storage:buckets:read` on it.

The failure mode is not subtle once it lands — the group loses the entire data type — but the statement *reads* as though it were scoped, so it tends to survive review.

Basic Policy Statements

```
// Grant read access to all logs
ALLOW storage:logs:read

// Grant read access to bucket metadata
// (storage:buckets:write does not exist — buckets are managed via the
//  Grail bucket-management API, not an IAM storage permission)
ALLOW storage:buckets:read

// Grant read AND write on logs — enumerate both actions.
// Wildcards (storage:logs:*) are rejected by the API (live-verified 07/2026).
ALLOW storage:logs:read, storage:logs:write
```

Common Services and Resources

Service	Resources	Common Actions
`storage`	`logs`, `spans`, `events`, `metrics`, `bizevents`, `entities`, `system`, `buckets`, `smartscape`	`read` on all; `write` ONLY on `logs`, `metrics`, `events` (never condition-scoped)
`settings`	`objects`, `schemas`	`read`, `write` (objects only)
`app`	`apps`, `functions`	`run`, `install`
`automation`	`workflows`	`read`, `write`, `run`
`document`	`documents`	`read`, `write`, `delete`, `share`

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3. Default Policies

Dynatrace provides **built-in (default) IAM policies** that cover common access patterns. They are managed by Dynatrace (not editable) and auto-adjust as the platform evolves.

> **Naming note:** The classic Gen2 roles "Dynatrace Viewer / Standard User / Professional User / Admin User" and "Data Viewer / Data Editor" are **not** current IAM policy names — they were RBAC roles. The names below are the current built-in IAM policies (see the default policies reference).

Platform Access Policies

Policy	Use Case	Grants
Standard User	Regular users	Access the environment and run Dynatrace Apps
Pro User	Power users	Build, deploy, and run apps + automated workflows
Admin User	Administrators	Administrative access across all Platform Services

There is **no built-in "Viewer" policy** — compose read-only access from a platform policy plus the granular data-read policies below.

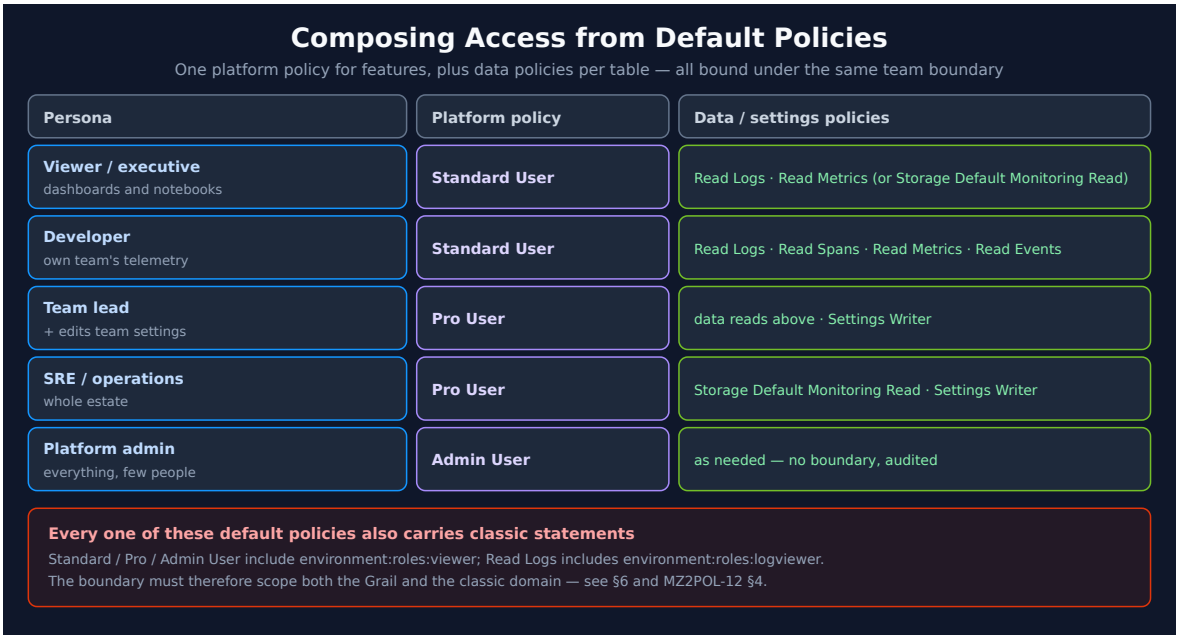
Data Access Policies

Policy	Use Case
All Grail data read access	Unrestricted read across all Grail tables and buckets
Storage Default Monitoring Read	Read on the default monitoring buckets; auto-extends as new tables are added
Read Logs / **Read Spans** / **Read Metrics** / **Read Events** / **Read Entities**	Granular read, one policy per signal type
Settings Reader / **Settings Writer**	Read / read-write of Settings 2.0 objects

Environment Role Policies (Classic surface)

Policy	Use Case
Environment role - Access environment	Viewer-level Classic environment access
Environment role - Change monitoring settings	Edit Classic monitoring settings

Choosing the Right Built-in Policies



> **Sources:** Dynatrace default policies reference (DT docs) — *"Read Logs Grants unconditional access to the logs table and all log buckets, including all custom log buckets."*

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4. Condition and Boundary Syntax

Policies and boundaries share the same condition syntax.

Supported Operators

Operator	Description	Example
`=`	Exact match	`field = "value"`
`!=`	Not equal	`field != "value"`
`startsWith`	Prefix match	`field startsWith "prefix"`
`in`	Value in list	`field in ("a", "b", "c")`
`IN`	Value in list (alternative)	`field IN ("a", "b")`
`MATCH`	Wildcard pattern match, any value of a list (only where the attribute lists it)	`field MATCH ('team-*')`

Not every operator applies to every attribute — the syntax page says so directly: *"Not every operator applies to every service attribute."* The IAM policy reference lists, per attribute:

Attribute	Operators
Grail record fields — `storage:dt.security_context`, `storage:dt.host_group.id`, `storage:k8s.namespace.name`, `storage:log.source` …	`=`, `IN`, `startsWith`, `MATCH` — **no negation**

Attribute	Operators
`storage:bucket-name`	`=`, `!=`, `IN`, `NOT IN`, `startsWith`, `NOT startsWith`, `MATCH`
`environment:management-zone` (on `environment:roles:*`)	`IN`, `startsWith`, `NOT startsWith`, `=`, `!=`, `MATCH`
`settings:schemaId`	`IN`, `=`, `!=`, `startsWith`, `NOT startsWith`

> **Sources:** IAM policy statement syntax and examples (DT docs), IAM policy reference (DT docs) — `storage:logs:read`: *"storage:dt.security_context - Custom field for security context."*
>
> **Place wildcards next to a word separator.** Dynatrace's guidance is to put the `*` immediately before or after a separator character — `-`, `_`, `.`, or `/` — because `MATCH("db-tech-*")` evaluates more efficiently than `MATCH("db-tech*")`. This is a performance rule rather than a correctness one, but it has a design consequence worth acting on: **build your `dt.security_context` values with explicit separators between dimensions** rather than running them together. A structured value such as `plat:k8s/comp:db/bu:digital/app:easytrade` gives every transversal team a boundary that lands cleanly on a separator, while a concatenated value like `k8sdbdigitaleasytrade` does not.
>
> Dimension **order** matters for the same reason: whichever dimension you place first is the one that prefix matching can slice on cheapest. Put the most transversal dimension — usually platform or component — at the front. See IAM-05 for the full boundary-design treatment.

Supported Fields

Field	Description	Used In
`environment`	Environment restrictions	Boundaries
`environment:name`	Environment by name	Boundaries
`environment:management-zone`	MZ-based (transitional)	Boundaries

Field	Description	Used In
`storage:dt.security_context`	Security context	Both
`storage:bucket-name`	Grail bucket	Both
`settings:schemaId`	Settings schema ID	Policies
`settings:dt.security_context`	Settings security context	Boundaries

Combining Conditions

AND logic (all conditions must match):

```
ALLOW storage:logs:read
  WHERE storage:dt.security_context = "team-a"
  AND storage:bucket-name = "production_logs"
```

OR logic (multiple statements or lines):

```
// In policies: Multiple statements
ALLOW storage:logs:read WHERE storage:dt.security_context = "team-a"
ALLOW storage:logs:read WHERE storage:dt.security_context = "team-b"

// In boundaries: repeated lines on the SAME condition multiply the statement
(OR)
storage:dt.security_context = "team-a"
storage:dt.security_context = "team-b"
```

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5. Creating Boundaries

Via UI

1. Navigate to **Account Management** → **Identity & Access Management**
2. Select **Policy Boundaries** → **Boundaries** tab
3. Click **Create boundary**
4. Enter:
   - **Boundary name**: Descriptive name
   - **Boundary query**: Restriction conditions

5. Click **Save**

Boundary Examples

Team-Based Boundary:

```
Name: Frontend Team Scope
Query: storage:dt.security_context = "team-frontend"
```

Environment Boundary:

```
Name: Production Only
Query: storage:dt.security_context startsWith "prod-"
```

Multi-Team Boundary (OR logic):

```
Name: Platform Teams
Query:
storage:dt.security_context = "team-infra"
storage:dt.security_context = "team-sre"
storage:dt.security_context = "team-platform"
```

Boundary Limitations

Limitation	Description	Workaround
Max 10 lines	Only 10 conditions per boundary	Create multiple boundaries — but see the row below on how they combine
No AND in lines	Each line is one condition	Lines on different conditions each scope their own permissions; for logical operators Dynatrace points to policy templating. Several boundaries on one binding are evaluated **separately** (a union), not combined — MZ2POL-12 §4
No complex expressions	Limited to basic operators	Simplify conditions

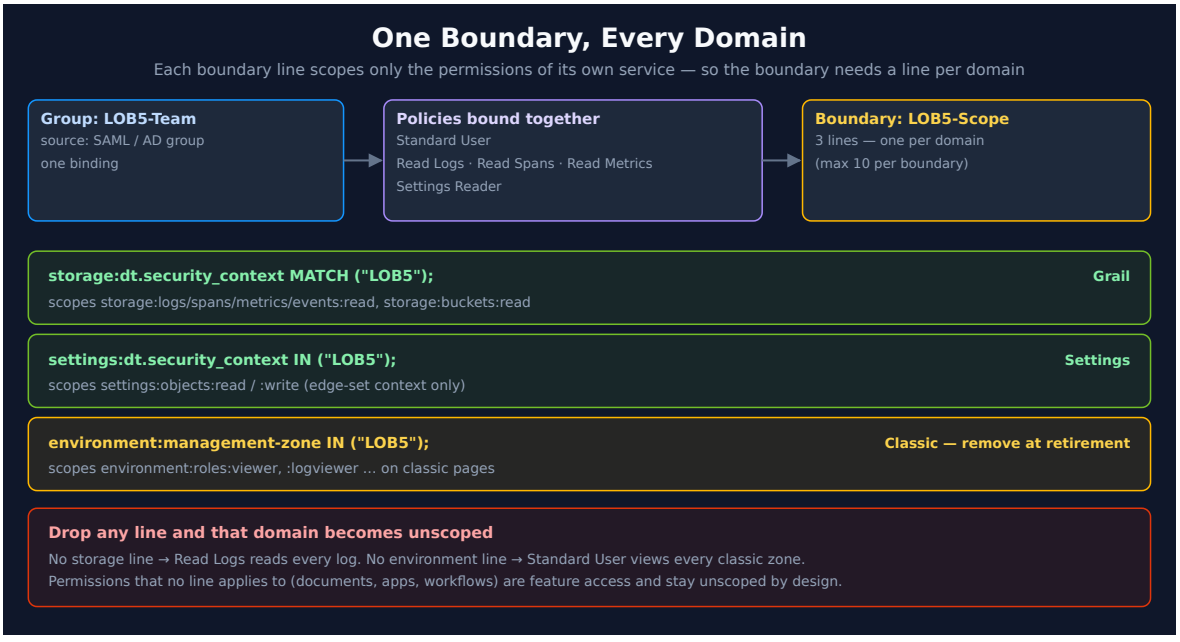
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6. Best Practice: One Boundary That Covers Every Domain

A boundary condition scopes only the permissions of its own service. Dynatrace's boundary rules: *"Only conditions added to service configuration will be applied to relative permissions."* The default policies bundle Grail, settings **and** classic statements — *Standard User* includes `environment:roles:viewer`, *Read Logs* includes `environment:roles:logviewer` — so a boundary that replicates a zone needs one line for **every domain the bound policies grant**. During the parallel run that is the zone line and the Grail lines, in the same boundary:

```
// Boundary "LOB5-Scope", bound with Standard User, Read Logs, Read Spans,
Read Metrics, Settings Reader
storage:dt.security_context MATCH ("LOB5");
settings:dt.security_context IN ("LOB5");
environment:management-zone IN ("LOB5");
```

The last line is transitional: it scopes the classic statements while classic pages are in use, and is deleted at retirement without rebinding anything. Dynatrace's own boundary page shows the same mixed shape — a `Kubernetes` boundary with an `environment:management-zone startsWith "[Kubernetes]"` line next to a `storage:k8s.namespace.name IN (...)` line.



> **`=` and `IN` only work while `dt.security_context` holds a single value.** Dynatrace's Grail permissions reference: *"Using `=`, `STARTSWITH` or `IN` when the field holds an array will always return `false`."* The failure is silent — the policy is valid, it evaluates, and it matches nothing. If any enrichment path can write an array into `dt.security_context`, use `MATCH` instead: *"you must use the `MATCH` operator to get 'for any value' set semantic."*
>
> On the validation tenant (10/13/2026) every `events` record with a security context held it as an array, while logs and spans held a string — so the Grail line above uses `MATCH`. Check your own tables with MZ2POL-12 §10 Check 1. **ORGNZ-04** covers the operator semantics in full.
>
> **Sources:** Permissions in Grail (DT docs) — the array semantics quoted above.

Two bindings instead of one boundary

An earlier version of this notebook recommended the opposite: never mix, and split into two parallel bindings — custom storage/settings policies under a Grail-only boundary, plus the classic *Environment role - Access environment* policy under a zone-only boundary. That design also works, and retirement becomes deleting one binding. Two corrections to how it was described:

- **Bindings combine as a union, not an intersection.** Each binding adds access; neither narrows the other. Dynatrace: *"When more than one boundary applies to a policy, then effective statements are calculated for each boundary separately"*.
- **It is only safe if each binding's policies stay inside its boundary's domain.** Bind *Standard User* or *Read Logs* under the Grail-only boundary and their classic statements come out unscoped; bind them under the zone-only boundary and their Grail statements do (MZ2POL-12 §4.2 walks through it).

If you split, use custom storage and settings statements in the Grail binding — one statement per service, rather than one `WHERE` mixing `storage:` and `settings:` conditions:

```
// Grail binding — custom policy, bound under a Grail-only boundary
ALLOW storage:logs:read, storage:spans:read, storage:metrics:read,
storage:events:read
  WHERE storage:dt.security_context MATCH ("LOB5");
ALLOW settings:objects:read, settings:objects:write
  WHERE settings:dt.security_context IN ("LOB5");

// Classic binding — transitional
ALLOW environment:roles:viewer
  WHERE environment:management-zone IN ("LOB5");
```

> **Sources: Policy boundaries (DT docs) — *"Only conditions added to service configuration will be applied to relative permissions."* and *"Be aware that the management zones referenced in your boundaries only apply to policy statements that support management zones."*, Dynatrace default policies reference (DT docs) — classic statements inside *Standard User* and *Read Logs*.**

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7. Recommended Group-Policy-Boundary Structure

For organizations using SAML/SSO with Active Directory, bind the group to default policies under **one** boundary that covers every domain (§6). Dynatrace's role-migration guide gives the same pattern: *"Make use of default policies whenever possible and define your business-specific access conditions in policy boundaries."*

Group (from AD)	Policies	Boundary
`LOB5-Team`	Standard User, Read Logs, Read Spans, Read Metrics, Read Events, Settings Reader	`LOB5-Scope` — the three lines in §6
`LOB5-Leads`	Pro User, Settings Writer, the same data reads	`LOB5-Scope`

Key Benefits

- **SAML group**: ties to existing AD group membership — no separate user management
- **One boundary per team**: every domain scoped in one reusable object; edits apply immediately to every binding that uses it
- **Clean retirement**: deleting the `environment:management-zone` line ends the classic scope without rebinding

Keep team groups free of unscoped data policies

Permissions are a union across every group a user belongs to. Dynatrace: *"If there is an unconditional table permission in any other policy available for a user, the WHERE clause is irrelevant and the user will always be able to view all records from that table."* A user in `LOB5-Team` who is also in an "all developers" group bound to *Read Logs* without a boundary reads every log. Audit group overlap before relying on any boundary — MZ2POL-12 §10 shows the effective-permissions API call.

> **Sources:** Upgrade role-based permissions to Dynatrace IAM policies (DT docs) — *"Make use of default policies whenever possible and define your business-specific access conditions in policy boundaries."*, Permissions in Grail (DT docs) — *"If there is an unconditional table permission in any other policy available for a user, the WHERE clause is irrelevant and the user will always be able to view all records from that table."*

Binding via UI

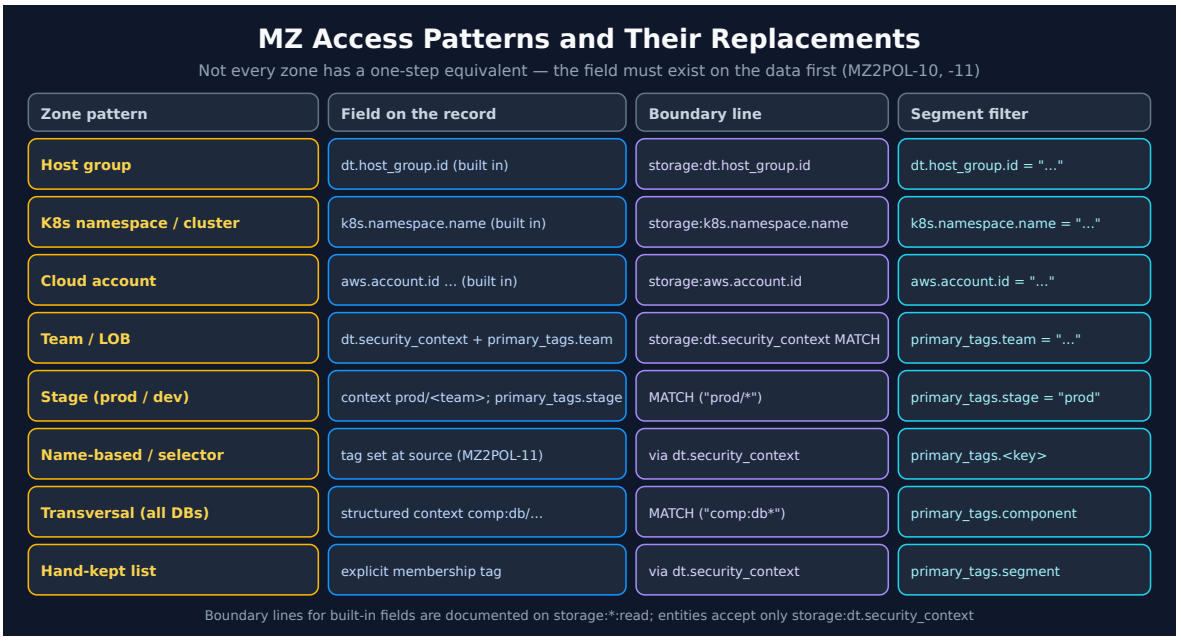
1. Navigate to **Group Management**
2. Select or create a group
3. Go to **Permissions** tab

4. Click **Add permission**
5. Select:
   - **Policy**: Choose policy to bind
   - **Boundary** (optional): Select restriction
   - **Environment**: Select target environment
6. Click **Save**

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8. Mapping MZ Access to Policies + Boundaries

Common MZ Permission Patterns



MZ Permission	Equivalent Policy + Boundary
View only	`Standard User` + data-read policies + Boundary
View + Edit	`Pro User` + `Settings Writer` + Boundary
Full access to MZ	`Pro User` + `All Grail data read access` + Boundary
Admin in MZ	`Admin User` (or a custom policy) + Boundary

Migration Example: Team-Based MZ

Before (MZ-based):
- Management Zone: "Frontend-Team"
- Rules: Services with tag `team:frontend`
- Users assigned via RBAC

After (Policy + Boundary):

```
1. Set security context on entities:
   - Services get dt.security_context = "team-frontend"

2. Create two parallel policy bindings — Gen3 with Gen3 boundary, Gen2 with
Gen2 boundary:

   Binding 1 — Gen3 (canonical):
     ALLOW storage:logs:read, storage:spans:read, storage:metrics:read,
           settings:objects:read, settings:objects:write
     WHERE storage:dt.security_context IN ("team-frontend")
       AND settings:dt.security_context IN ("team-frontend");
     (policy WHERE uses AND, not OR — each condition scopes its own service)

   Binding 2 — Gen2 (transitional, until MZ retirement):
     ALLOW environment:roles:viewer
     WHERE environment:management-zone IN ("Frontend-Team");

3. Attach both bindings to the group:
   Group: Frontend Developers (SAML)
   Bindings: Gen3 binding + Gen2 binding (both active during migration window)
```

Migration Example: Environment MZ

Before (MZ-based):
- Management Zone: "Production"
- Rules: Hosts with tag `env:production`
- Users get MZ-filtered view

After (Policy + Boundary):

```
1. Set security context on entities:
   - Hosts get dt.security_context = "prod-{region}"

2. Create two boundaries (don't mix Gen2 and Gen3 in one):
   Gen3 boundary "Production - Grail":
     storage:dt.security_context startsWith "prod-";
     settings:dt.security_context startsWith "prod-";
   Gen2 boundary "Production - Classic":
     environment:management-zone IN ("Production");

3. Bind to group with two parallel bindings:
   Group: Production Operators (SAML)
   Binding 1 (Gen3): Pro User + data-read policies, Boundary "Production -
Grail"
   Binding 2 (Gen2): Environment role - Access environment, Boundary
"Production - Classic"
```

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9. Security Context and Bucket Strategy

What Is Security Context?

Security Context (`dt.security_context`) is a special field on Grail records — logs, spans, metrics, events, user events — and on entities. It is the one record field that every Grail table accepts in an IAM condition, which makes it the recommended way to scope boundaries for Grail data (MZ2POL-12 §1).

Primary Grail Fields

When migrating from Management Zones, leverage **Primary Grail Fields** for consistent data partitioning:

Field	Source	MZ Migration Use
`k8s.cluster.name`	Kubernetes	Replace cluster-based MZs
`k8s.namespace.name`	Kubernetes	Replace namespace-based MZs
`aws.account.id`	AWS metadata	Replace AWS account MZs
`dt.host_group.id`	OneAgent config	Replace host group-based MZs

Bucket Strategy for Migration

Buckets partition Grail data and integrate with policies and boundaries for team-level access control.

Bucket Limitations

> ⚠️ **Critical:** Plan buckets carefully during migration - these constraints cannot be changed later.

Limitation	Details
One data type per bucket	Logs, metrics, events, OR spans - not mixed
Names are immutable	Bucket names CANNOT be changed after creation
No data migration	Data CANNOT be moved between buckets
Naming rules	3-100 chars, lowercase alphanumeric, underscores, hyphens only
Maximum buckets	80 per environment (default limit)
Optimal ingest	~1 TB/day per bucket for best query performance
Acceptable ingest	1-3 TB/day per bucket (limited query window)
Maximum ingest	No hard per-bucket cap is documented — Dynatrace describes ingesting *"well over 15 TB per day into a single bucket"* when queries stay within narrow timeframes. A larger bucket costs queryable window per scan, and Dynatrace pages give different split points (Partition data (DT docs), Logs bucket strategy (DT docs))

Query Constraints

Limit	Value	Impact
Maximum data scanned	500 GB	Limits queryable time window
Maximum records returned	1,000	Use aggregations for larger datasets
Maximum response payload	1 MB	Large result sets may be truncated

Default Bucket Retentions

Bucket	Retention
`default_logs`	35 days
`default_metrics`	15 months
`default_spans`	10 days
`default_events`	35 days

Using Buckets for Team Isolation (MZ Replacement)

When replacing team-based MZs, use buckets in **both policies AND boundaries**:

Either one boundary covering every domain (§6), or two bindings whose policies stay inside their boundary's domain. The two-binding form, with buckets added:

```
// Gen3 policy
ALLOW storage:logs:read,
      storage:spans:read,
      storage:metrics:read,
      settings:objects:read,
      settings:objects:write;
```

```
// Gen3 boundary — scoped by bucket + security context
storage:bucket-name          IN ("frontend_logs", "frontend_spans",
"frontend_metrics");
storage:dt.security_context  IN ("team-frontend");
settings:dt.security_context IN ("team-frontend");
```

```
// Gen2 policy – Classic entity access, transitional
ALLOW environment:roles:viewer;
```

```
// Gen2 boundary
environment:management-zone IN ("Frontend-Team");
```

> **`MATCH` is not Gen3-only.** The IAM policy reference lists it for `environment:management-zone` on the classic `environment:roles:*` permissions as well as for the Grail record fields. What matters is the pattern: `MATCH("*")` matches everything on any attribute. Note too that `storage:entities:read` is a Grail permission — it accepts only `storage:dt.security_context` and `storage:entity.type`.

Migration Mapping: MZ to Buckets

MZ Pattern	Bucket Strategy
Team MZ (e.g., "Frontend-Team")	Team-specific buckets: `frontend_logs`, `frontend_spans`
Environment MZ (e.g., "Production")	Environment buckets: `prod_logs`, `prod_metrics`
Regional MZ (e.g., "US-East")	Region buckets: `useast_logs`, `useast_spans`
Compliance MZ (e.g., "PCI")	Compliance buckets: `pci_logs`, `pci_events`

Complete Team Migration Example

Before (MZ-based):
- Management Zone: "Checkout-Team"
- Users see all data within the MZ

After (Policy + Bucket + Boundary):

```
Group: Checkout-Team (SAML from AD)
├── Policy: Checkout Data Access
│   ├── ALLOW storage:logs:read WHERE storage:bucket-name = "checkout_logs"
│   ├── ALLOW storage:spans:read WHERE storage:bucket-name = "checkout_spans"
│   └── ALLOW storage:metrics:read WHERE storage:bucket-name =
"checkout_metrics"
└── Boundary:
    storage:bucket-name IN ("checkout_logs", "checkout_spans",
"checkout_metrics");
    storage:dt.security_context IN ("checkout");
    environment:management-zone IN ("Checkout-Team");
```

> **For detailed bucket design guidance**, see **ORGNZ-03: Bucket Strategy and Design** which covers naming conventions, retention planning, and cost attribution patterns in depth.

Setting Security Context

Security context is set on the data, at the source — MZ2POL-10 §5 has the full ladder:
- **OneAgent host tag** — `oneagentctl --set-host-tag="dt.security_context=<value>"` or at install
- `DT_TAGS` on a single process, for shared hosts
- **Kubernetes** namespace labels or annotations, **OpenTelemetry** resource attributes
- **Central configuration** (Ingest enrichment configuration, cloud and Kubernetes rules)
- **OpenPipeline** *Set security context* processors — after routing, so last resort

Auto-tagging rules do **not** set it on Grail data: they *"have no effect on Smartscape on Grail"*. The entity-side *Grail Security Context* mapping can copy management-zone names onto entities, but data records *"do not inherit the management zones of that entity"* — and MZ-derived contexts stop matching for scoped settings (MZ2POL-12 §5).

> **Sources:** Differences between classic auto-tagging and primary Grail tags (DT docs) — *"Auto-tagging rules have no effect on Smartscape on Grail and are not used in any Latest Dynatrace app."*, Grant access to entities with security context (DT docs) — *"Logs, spans, metrics, and events powered by Grail that are sent from an entity do not inherit the management zones of that entity."*

Security Context Naming Strategy

Pattern	Example	Use Case
`team-{name}`	`team-frontend`	Team ownership
`env-{name}`	`env-production`	Environment separation
`region-{code}`	`region-us-east`	Geographic isolation
`app-{name}`	`app-checkout`	Application scoping
`{env}-{team}`	`prod-frontend`	Combined scoping

> **For transversal access patterns** (teams spanning multiple applications by component type — database, networking, OS), consider a structured multi-dimensional format: `comp:<component>/bu:<business-unit>/app:<application>`. This enables `MATCH('comp:db*')` to reach all database layers across all applications, while `MATCH('*/app:easytrade')` scopes to all components of one app. The dimension you need for transversal slicing must come *first* for Classic entity access. See **IAM-04: Policy Authoring** for the complete design pattern.

Query Entities by Security Context

```
// List services with their security context
// Identify services that need security context assignment
fetch dt.entity.service
| fields entity.name,
         dt.security_context,
         tags,
         managementZones
| sort dt.security_context asc
| limit 50

// Note: dt.entity.* is deprecated, but this is a migration-ASSESSMENT query —
it inspects
// the classic constructs this migration replaces, so keep the classic query
above:
//   - management zones have NO Smartscape node equivalent; they are what this
migration
//     replaces with segments and policies.
//   - dt.security_context is an ARRAY on Smartscape nodes (empty [] when
unset, not null),
//     so isNull / isNotNull(dt.security_context) does not carry over — a
Smartscape rewrite
//     would miscount coverage.
//   - entity tags are not a flat "tags" field on Smartscape (resolve via
getNodeField).
```

```
// Count entities by security context
// Helps verify security context distribution
fetch dt.entity.service
| summarize count = count(), by:{dt.security_context}
| sort count desc

// Note: dt.entity.* is deprecated, but this is a migration-ASSESSMENT query —
it inspects
// the classic constructs this migration replaces, so keep the classic query
above:
//   - dt.security_context is an ARRAY on Smartscape nodes (empty [] when
unset, not null),
//     so isNull / isNotNull(dt.security_context) does not carry over — a
Smartscape rewrite
//     would miscount coverage.
```

---

10. Custom Policies

When to Create Custom Policies

- Default policies are too broad or narrow
- Need specific permission combinations
- Require conditional access
- Compliance requirements

Custom Policy Examples

Log Viewer for Specific Team:

```
// Policy Name: Frontend Team Log Access
// Description: Read-only access to frontend service logs

ALLOW storage:logs:read
  WHERE storage:dt.security_context = "team-frontend"

ALLOW storage:spans:read
  WHERE storage:dt.security_context = "team-frontend"
```

Environment-Restricted Admin:

```
// Policy Name: Development Admin
// Description: Full access to development environment only

// Reads are condition-scoped; storage writes cannot take WHERE conditions
// (live-verified) — grant them unscoped only where justified.
// Caution: event records hold dt.security_context as an ARRAY, and startsWith
never
// matches an array — test that this grants storage:events:read before relying
on it.
ALLOW storage:logs:read, storage:spans:read, storage:metrics:read,
      storage:events:read, storage:bizevents:read,
      storage:entities:read, storage:system:read, storage:buckets:read
  WHERE storage:dt.security_context startsWith "dev-"

ALLOW settings:objects:read, settings:objects:write
  WHERE settings:scope startsWith "environment:dev"
```

Dashboard and Notebook Creator:

```
// Policy Name: Dashboard Creator
// Description: Create and manage dashboards and notebooks

ALLOW document:documents:read
ALLOW document:documents:write
ALLOW document:documents:delete
ALLOW document:direct-shares:write

// Read data for dashboards
ALLOW storage:logs:read
ALLOW storage:metrics:read
ALLOW storage:spans:read
```

---

11. Best Practices

Do's

- ✅ **Start with default policies** - customize only when needed
- ✅ **Use least privilege** - grant minimum required permissions
- ✅ **Document policies and boundaries** - clear names and descriptions
- ✅ **Test before production** - verify with test users
- ✅ **Use boundaries for scope** - keep policies reusable
- ✅ **Cover every domain the bound policies grant** — storage, settings, and environment while classic pages are used (§6)
- ✅ **Use SAML groups** tied to AD for team management

Don'ts

- ❌ **Don't create policy per user** - use groups
- ❌ **Don't duplicate default policies** - extend instead
- ❌ **Don't use overly broad wildcards** - be specific
- ❌ **Don't embed conditions in policies** when boundaries are better
- ❌ **Don't forget the settings domain** in boundaries

Naming Conventions

```
// Good names
"Frontend Team - Standard Access"     (policy)
"Production Environment"              (boundary)
"LOB5-Scope"                          (boundary)

// Bad names
"Policy 1"
"Test"
"John's boundary"
```

Audit Checklist

- [ ] Each boundary has a clear purpose
- [ ] Boundary names follow naming convention
- [ ] All three domains included (environment, storage, settings)
- [ ] SAML groups aligned with AD structure
- [ ] Dependencies tracked (which policies use which boundaries)
- [ ] Regular review scheduled

---

12. Troubleshooting

Common Issues

Issue	Likely Cause	Solution
User can't access anything	No policy bound	Bind policy to user's group
User sees too much	Boundary too broad or missing	Tighten boundary conditions
User can't see expected data	Missing data policy	Add a data-read policy (e.g. `Read Logs` / `All Grail data read access`)
Permissions inconsistent	Multiple conflicting policies	Review all bound policies

Issue	Likely Cause	Solution
Works in classic, not Grail	Only environment domain used	Add the storage line to the same boundary (§6)
User sees **all** logs despite a boundary	Zone-only boundary on a default policy, or an unscoped data policy in another of the user's groups	Add the storage line; audit group overlap (§7, MZ2POL-12 §3–4)
User sees every classic zone	Standard User bound under a Grail-only boundary	Add the `environment:management-zone` line (§6)
Settings not restricted	Missing settings domain	Add `settings:dt.security_context` boundary

Debugging Steps

1. **Verify group membership**: Is user in correct group?
2. **Check policy bindings**: What policies are bound to group?
3. **Review boundaries**: Are both Gen3 and Gen2 boundaries attached where needed?
4. **Test with admin**: Does admin see the data?
5. **Check security context**: Is it set on the entities?

Testing Boundaries

1. **Create test user** in target group
2. **Log in as test user**
3. **Verify access**:
   - Can access expected data?
   - Cannot access restricted data?
4. **Test edge cases**:
   - Entities at boundary edges
   - New entities without security context

Summary

In this notebook, you learned:

1. **Policies define WHAT**, boundaries define **WHERE**
2. **Default policies** cover most use cases - customize only when needed
3. **Shared syntax** for conditions in both policies and boundaries
4. **Three domains** needed for complete MZ replacement (environment, storage, settings)
5. **SAML + Policy + Boundary** structure for AD integration
6. **Migration patterns** for team-based and environment-based MZs

Next Steps

Continue to **MZ2POL-05: Segments Implementation** to:
- Create DQL-based data filters
- Replace MZ data filtering with Segments
- Configure cross-app filtering

For the end-to-end design — evaluation rules, the boundary pitfalls, the scoped-settings change and persona walkthroughs — see **MZ2POL-12: IAM Reference Architecture**.

For large-scale migrations with many Management Zones, see **MZ2POL-08: Templated Policies for MZ Migration** to:
- Convert MZ patterns to parameterized policy templates
- Automate bulk policy binding via IAM API
- Validate migrated access with DQL queries

Additional Resources

- Working with Policies
- IAM Policy Reference
- Policy Boundaries Documentation
- Grant Access with Security Context
- Policy Templating
- Use Grail buckets to partition data — bucket-level access control, and why a `DENY` scopes buckets but not records

This notebook was AI-generated from community-submitted and publicly available sources. This notebook series is not officially supported by Dynatrace. Always verify information against official Dynatrace documentation.